Benchmark reference answer

Question	How many MPs sit in the House of Commons?
Essential The very minimum an answer needs to include to be accurate. *Answers containing or requiring only this are sufficient.*	650, or a lower number that accounts for temporary vacancies or non-sitting MPs, as long as 650 is still mentioned.
Good answer If there is more to add that serves a user's needs, for instance to clarify or substantiate the minimum viable answer. It should **not** include context, just information directly relevant to the question asked. *Answers requiring and containing these are good (they may not necessarily need to include everything here).* *This section is **optional.***	Any caveat that says there are not always exactly 650 (due to temporary vacancies) or that some MPs don't technically "sit" (Sinn Fein).
Background Frequently used facts not deemed essential — use as a reference guide for annotators. *Things like context, qualifications, citations, definitions, timeframes etc that don't serve to answer the question.*	The number of MPs has been 650 since the 2010 election, before which it was 646. MPs are elected to 650 single-member constituencies. Constituency boundaries were last reviewed in 2023, but kept the number at 650. There are 7 Sinn Fein MPs who don't take their seats. The number isn't always 650 because MPs can die or resign, leaving temporary vacancies. Not all MPs vote, including the Speaker and Deputy Speakers. The 650 breaks down into 543 in England, 57 in Scotland, 32 in Wales and 18 in Northern Ireland.